

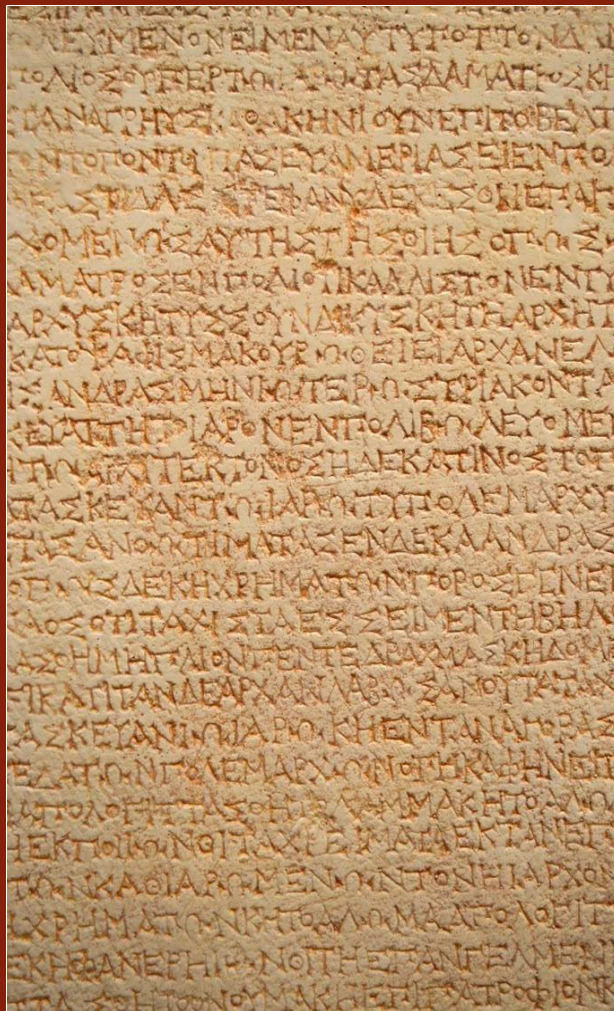
SunoikisisDC Spring 2026
Session 7

Epigraphic Object Encoding

Gabriel Bodard (London)
Anna Clara Maniero Azzolini (London)
Polina Yordanova-Nanev (Helsinki)

Outline

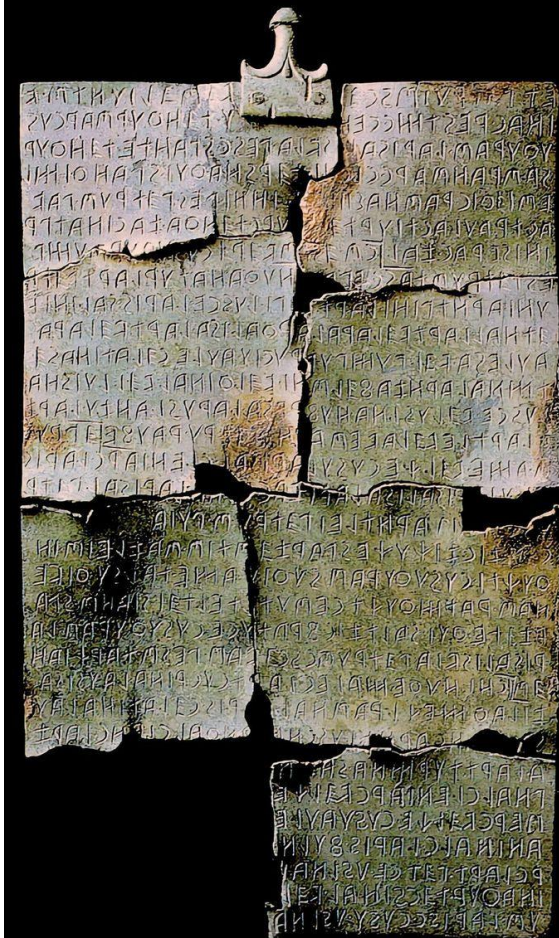
- What is epigraphy?
- What is text encoding?
- Encoding text transcription
- Encoding object description
- Vocabularies and Wikidata
- VSC demo and exercise
- Discussion



WHAT IS --- EPIGRAPHY?

ἐπιγράφειν

- It's the study of **inscriptions** on every hard and (potentially) long-lasting material from any **time** and **place**.
- Ex. From a jumble of letters scrawled on a wall to a large marble slab inscribed with sacred law.
- «paint», «marble», «sacred», «law», «letters», «time», «space» these are just a few examples of the **interdisciplinary** nature of Epigraphy.
- Palaeography, History, Archaeology, Prosopography, Philology, Literature, Geology...
- True or False?



Should we distinguish between manufacture and text?

When epigraphy first emerged as a discipline, the two dimensions were largely treated as one — and priority was given to the text.

We now give both aspects their due value.

The object itself can be as eloquent as the words it bears.

Manufact and text



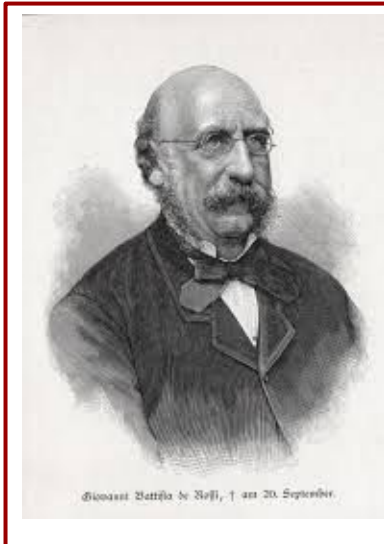
The beginning of a discipline



Theodor
Mommsen
(1817-1903)



August Böckh
(1785-1867)



Giovanni Battista
de Rossi
(1822-1894)



Wilhelm
Henzen
(1816-1887)

From the *field* to the *screen*



Collecting, analysing and comparing (but also travelling, climbing, and dusting).



Yet the discipline did not develop only in the field: it also took shape in libraries, in private and public collections, and in the dense web of correspondence between scholars.



Nowadays collecting means digitising information about the text and the manufacture, making it accessible to all scholars.

in latere navis, ENNIA · P · L · VENERIA
 cuius in velo SIBI ET
 crux est; gubernator nim- T·TROSIO·T·F·SECUNDO
 dum habet T·SAVFEIO·STEIPANI·L etc
 5 M A G I R O · V

Contuli. Antiquus habet, scilicet Marcanova cod. Bern. n. 425, cod. Mut. f. 177' n. 8; Felicianus n. 10; Ferrarinus cod. Trai. f. 52, cod. Reg. n. 10; Redianus f. 51 n. 6; Gammarus f. 82'; Lilius f. 58; Iucundus f. 191 (inde male per Gorium Mur. 1632, 1); Sanutus f. 50'; Apianus 324, 5 (inde Grut. 973, 3); Trivisan *lagune* ed. 2 p. 67 (a quo videntur pendere Rocco Curti f. 693 et chron. Anonymi in cod. Cicognae 2979) item ex codice simili opinor. Denuo ex lapide Manutius cod. Vat. 5248 p. 1 (ibidem p. 8 legitur ex Marcanova descripta, emendata ad lapidem); Moschini *itin. de la ville de Venise* (1819)

Record Number: EDR099225 TM Number: [126022](#)

Ancient Region: VeH

Current Region: I

Ancient City: Altinum [TMGEO](#)

Modern City: Quarto d'Altino (Venezia), frazione Altino

Discovery Location: Venezia, San Pietro di Castello, basamento del campanile

Current Location: Venezia, Seminario Patriarcale, lapidario. Inv. chiostro 54

Object Type: cinerarium

Material: lapis

Measurements: Height: 40.5 Length: 71 Width/Diam.: 35 litt. alt.: 5-6,5

State of textual preservation: tit. integer

Writing Technique: scalpro

Language: latina

Religion: Pagana

Inscription type: sepulcralis

Type of persons mentioned: cet.

Bibliography: CIL 05, 02225 (1)

Guida del visitatore artista attraverso il Seminario Patriarcale di Venezia, Venezia 1912, pp. 70-73, r. G. Marzemin, Le origini romane di Venezia, Venezia 1937, p. 168 (3)

Ant. A. Adr., 46, 2001, p. 302, nt. 29 (M. Tirelli) (4)

Altino antica. Dai Veneti a Venezia, Venezia 2011, p. 193, nr. 71, con foto (L. Calvelli) (5)

Colons et colonies dans le monde romain, Roma 2012, pp. 398-405, con foto (G. Cresci Marrone) - AE 2012, 0553 (7)

Cfr. L'iscrizione esposta. Atti del Convegno Borghesi 2015, Faenza 2016, pp. 476-477, con foto (L.

Text:

Ennia P(ubli) l(iberta) Veneria

sibi et

T(ito) Trosio T(iti) f(ilio) Secundo

T(ito) Saufeio Steipani l(iberto)

5 Magiro v(iva) f(ecit).

[Show corrections/normalizations](#)

Apparatus: Textus secundum (6), contulit Calvelli a. 2002

Date: 30 a.C. / 30 d.C. (palaeographia; archaeologia)

Author: Lorenzo Calvelli Last update: 05-08-2019 (21-08-2021)

THE LEIDEN SYSTEM

1932

<i>a(bc)</i>	expansion of words abbreviated in the inscription
<i>ab[c]</i>	restoration of letters now lost through damage or loss of part of the inscription
ABC	letters are clear, but their significance is uncertain
<i>ā b̄ d̄ s̄</i>	only a small part of the letter survives as a result of damage or loss of part of the inscription, but it can be restored from the context
+ + +	traces of letters visible on the stone, but it is impossible to recognize what they are; one cross stands for each letter.
abc	letters were seen by a previous editor but are no longer visible
á é í ó ú	vowels marked with an <i>apex</i>
ì	l longa
<i>âb</i>	letters joined together in a <i>nexus</i>
[.]	one letter is lost that cannot be restored
[...]	letters lost that cannot be restored, the precise number of which can be conjectured (one full-stop for each lost letter)
[-c.5-]	letters lost that cannot be restored, the approximate number of which can be conjectured
[- - -]	letters lost that cannot be restored and their precise number cannot be conjectured

[- - - - -]	loss of complete line
- - - - -	loss of complete lines but their precise number cannot be ascertained
[[<i>abc</i>]]	letters erased from the original inscription
[[[<i>abc</i>]]]	letters erased from the original inscription, which the editors can restore
((<i>abc</i>))	the editor's explanation of letters or symbols
{ <i>abc</i> }	additional letters inscribed in error but suppressed by the editor
< <i>abc</i> >	letters incorrectly omitted but added by the editor
<< <i>abc</i> >>	letters inscribed in an erasure
⌈ <i>abc</i> ⌋	letters erroneously inscribed, but corrected by the editor
(vac)	space where no letters are inscribed
<i>D • M • S</i>	interpunction between words or letters
⊂ columbia ⊃	image inserted into the inscription and described by the editor, commonly using Latin words

An example



Original
layout

Expansion of
abbreviation

Nexus

Ennia P(ubli) l(iberta) Veneria
sibi et
T(ito) Trosio T(iti) f(ilio) Secuñdo
T(ito) Saufeio Steipani l(iberto)
Magiro v(iva) f(ecit).

Letter no longer visible

Higher letter

```
<expan>
  <abbr>
    <am>
      <g type="year">\</g>
    </am>
  </abbr>
  <ex>ἔτους</ex>
</expan>
```

WHAT IS TEXT ENCODING?

Example of text encoding: *copy editing*

- Text
- Editorial markup
- Instructions for formatting and printing

Abstract	206410 Deleted: 5
Most actors in the debate assume that the intuitive variability of proper assertion with practical stakes (the Shiftiness Intuition) motivates the following dilemma: either 1) we embrace a <u>knowledge norm of assertion</u>, and are forced into a view that takes knowledge, or 'knowledge', to be sensitive to practical stakes, or 2) we stick to our classical invariantist guns, but then the knowledge norm goes out the window and we get practical sensitivity in the normativity of assertion (the Shiftiness Dilemma). This chapter brings this dilemma to centre stage and argues that it threatens to generalize in three ways: to all context-invariant norms of proper assertoric speech, to all constative speech acts, and to all epistemic normative constraints. If this is right, we should be more worried about this dilemma than we've been so far.	AQ: In this chapter I have followed your predominant style of initial capitals to the Knowledge Norm of Assertion but not indefinite (a knowledge norm of assertion).
Keywords contextualism; epistemic norm; knowledge norm; stakes; assertion; bank cases; Classical Invariantism; pragmatic encroachment; subject-sensitive invariantism;	Deleted: c Deleted: c Deleted: i

IN MARGIN	IN TEXT	IN MARGIN	IN TEXT
a	insert word or letter	sc	set in <u>small capital letters</u> (SMALL CAPITAL LETTERS)
e	delete; delete and close up space	Cap	change from lowercase to <u>capital</u> (Capital)
e	close up space	ital	set in <u>italic</u> or slanted type (<i>italic</i>)
#	insert space	rom	set in <u>Roman</u> type (Roman)
eq #	equalize space; make space between words or lines equal	bf	set in <u>boldface</u> type (boldface)
no	begin new paragraph or continue last paragraph	wf	wrong <u>front</u> or type style or size; set in <u>correct</u> type (correct type)
# #	center	↑	insert comma
[]	flush left	⋮	insert period or colon
fi	flush right	⋮	insert double quotation marks (The Catbird Seat)
fr	reverse the order; transpose	↓	insert single quotation mark or apostrophe (today's newspaper)
tr	ragged margin; don't justify lines	≡	insert hyphen (first-class)
⋮	move text down; move text up	1/4	insert en dash (3-4 credits)
⋮	superscript or subscript 2 (π ² or H ₂ O)	1/2	insert em dash (required courses-stand-alones or clusters)
sp	spell out (set 1 hr. as one hour)	set ?	insert question mark (Who's on first)
stet	don't change; go back to the original	=	insert equals sign (1+1=2)
lc	change from <u>capital</u> to lowercase letter (capital)	() []	insert parentheses or square brackets

Digital text encoding

- *Standardized, structured, machine readable*
- TEI (Text Encoding Initiative), since 1988:
 - International standard for encoding texts
 - Uses eXtensible Markup Language (XML)
 - Designed to represent structure, editorial decisions, and textual features
 - Guidelines and standardization
 - Highly customisable



```
<TEI>
  <teiHeader>metadata</teiHeader>
  <text>
    <body>encoded text</body>
  </text>
</TEI>
```

EpiDoc

- Subset of TEI for epigraphic materials
- A collection and standardization of the best existing practices for encoding epigraphic materials in machine-readable form:
 - Leiden System Distinctions
 - Existing standards for corpus and database fields
- Expanded for neighbouring disciplines:
 - Papyrology, numismatics, sigillography...
 - Other scripts – Cuneiform, Mayan, Mycenaean...
- Guidelines, schema, template, example XSLT, visualisation platform, converters
- Active and collaborative community



EpiDoc timeline

- **1932** Leiden System
- **1999** EAGLE Commission for Epigraphy and Information Technology:
Prof. Silvio Panciera's manifesto
- **2000** Tom Elliott, Hugh Cayless, Amy Hawkins (Ancient World Mapping Center, UNC-CH)
 - EpiDoc Guidelines, version 1
- **2002-2004** EpiDoc pilot projects: Inscriptions of Aphrodisias, Vindolanda Tablets
- **2007-2011** Integrating Digital Papyrology (IDP) project:
 - Papyrological Navigator (PN) – search and browse platform
 - Son of Suda Online (SoSOL) – Leiden+
 - Papyri.info
- **Ongoing development and community activity**
 - Dissemination and training
 - Regular updates to the guidelines and schema
(<https://epidoc.stoa.org/gl/latest/> version 9.8)

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://relxng.org/ns/structure/1.0"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://purl.oclc.org/dsdl/schematron"?>
<TEI xmlns="http://www.tei-c.org/ns/1.0" xml:space="preserve" xml:lang="en">
```

```
<teiHeader>
  <fileDesc>
    <titleStmnt>
      <title>title of document</title>
    </titleStmnt>
    <publicationStmnt>
      <authority/>
      <idno type="filename"></idno>
    </publicationStmnt>
    <sourceDesc>
      <msIdentifier>
        <repository>museum/archive</repository>
        <idno>inventory number</idno>
      </msIdentifier>
      <physDesc>
        <objectDesc>
          <supportDesc>
            <support>description of object/monument (likely to include <material/>
              and <objectType/> information, <dimensions/>, etc.)</support>
          </supportDesc>
          <layoutDesc>
            <layout>description of text field/campus</layout>
          </layoutDesc>
          <objectDesc>
            <handNote>description of letters, possibly including <height>letter-heights</height>
          </handNote>
        </objectDesc>
      </physDesc>
      <history>
        <origin>
          <origPlace>Place of origin</origPlace>
          <origDate>Date of origin</origDate>
        </origin>
        <provenance type="found"> Findspot and circumstances/context
        </provenance>
        <provenance type="observed">Modern location(s) (if different from repository, above)
        </provenance>
      </history>
    </msDesc>
    </sourceDesc>
  </fileDesc>
  <profileDesc>
    <textClass>
      <keywords>
        <term>Type of text</term>
      </keywords>
    </textClass>
  </profileDesc>
</teiHeader>
```

teiHeader

- repository
- physical description (object, layout, and writing)
- origin, findspot and circumstances, location of observation

facsimile: images

```
<facsimile>
  <graphic url="path/to/photograph_of_text_or_monument"/>
</facsimile>
```

text

- text, apparatus, translations, commentary, bibliography

```
<text>
  <body>
    <div type="edition" xml:space="preserve">
      <ab>
        <lb n="1">Greek or Latin (etc.) text here
      </ab>
    </div>
    <div type="apparatus">
      <p>external apparatus criticus (if applicable)</p>
    </div>
    <div type="translation">
      <p>translation(s)</p>
    </div>
    <div type="commentary">
      <p>commentary</p>
    </div>
    <div type="bibliography">
      <p>bibliography of previous editions, discussion, etc.</p>
    </div>
  </body>
</text>
```

```
</TEI>
```



Κατεσκευ[άσθη ...]
ἐπὶ τῶν εὐσ[εβεστάτων ...]

Κατεσκευ<supplied
reason="lost">άσθη</supplied> <gap
reason="lost" extent="unknown"
unit="character"/>

ἐπὶ τῶν εὐ<unclear>σ</unclear><supplied
reason="lost">εβεστάτων</supplied> <gap
reason="lost" extent="unknown"
unit="character"/>

ENCODING TEXT TRANSCRIPTION

...	Illegible letters, not restored by editor.
ab	Letters ambiguous without their context.
[...]	Letters missing, not restored by editor.
[abc]	Letters missing, restored by editor.
<...>	Letters erroneously omitted, not restored.
<abc>	Letters erroneously omitted, restored by editor.
a(bc)	Abbreviation expanded by editor.
{abc}	Letters considered superfluous by editor.
[[abc]]	Deletion which can be restored.

... `<gap reason="illegible" extent="unknown"/>`

ab `<unclear>ab</unclear>`

[...] `<gap reason="lost" extent="unknown"/>`

[abc] `<supplied reason="lost">abc</supplied>`

<...> `<gap reason="omitted" extent="unknown"/>`

<abc> `<supplied reason="omitted">abc</supplied>`

a(bc) `<expan><abbr>a</abbr><ex>be</ex></expan>`

{abc} `<surplus>abc</surplus>`

[[abc]] `<del>abc</del>`

Simple Leiden → TEI substitution

Text deliberately erased in antiquity

Leiden: [[abc]] *or* [[*abc*]]

EpiDoc: <del rend="erasure">abc

Simple Leiden → TEI substitution

Superfluous letters, suppressed by editor (e.g. dittography)

Leiden: {abc}

EpiDoc: **<surplus>abc</surplus>**

Not simple bracket substitution

Characters that would be ambiguous outside their context

Leiden: **ȁȃȅ**

EpiDoc: **<unclear>abc</unclear>**

Not simple bracket substitution

Characters lost (lacuna), partially restored

Leiden: Κατεσκευ[άσθη ...]

EpiDoc: Κατεσκευsuppliedabc</supplied><gap/>

Not simple bracket substitution

Characters lost (lacuna), partially restored

Leiden: Κατεσκευ[άσθη] [...]

EpiDoc: Κατεσκευ<supplied>abc</supplied><gap/>

Not simple bracket substitution

Characters lost (lacuna), partially restored

Leiden: Κατεσκευ[άσθη ...]

EpiDoc: Κατεσκευ<supplied>abc</supplied><gap/>

When Leiden is more expressive than TEI

Characters lost, restored by the editor

Leiden: [abcd]

EpiDoc: **<supplied reason="lost">abcd</supplied>**

When Leiden is more expressive than TEI

Characters omitted, added by the editor

Leiden: `<abc>`

EpiDoc: `<supplied reason="omitted">abc</supplied>`

When Leiden is more expressive than TEI

Word understood, spelled out by the editor

Leiden: (i.e. *femina*)

EpiDoc:

<supplied reason="subaudible">*femina*</supplied>

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Erroneous or substituted letters corrected by the editor

Leiden: 「abc」 or *<abc>*

EpiDoc: **<choice><sic>xyz</sic>
<corr>abc</corr></choice>**

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Erroneous or substituted letters corrected by the editor

Leiden: 「abc」

EpiDoc: **<choice><sic>xyz</sic>
<corr>abc</corr></choice>**

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Text struck *in rasura* (or error corrected in antiquity)

Leiden: 《abc》 *or* <<abc>>

EpiDoc: **<subst>xyz
 <add>abc</add></subst>**

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Text struck *in rasura* (or error corrected in antiquity)

Leiden: 《abc》

EpiDoc: <subst>xyz
 <add>abc</add></subst>

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Letters representing numeral

Leiden: ρα'

EpiDoc: <num>ρα</num>

When TEI is more expressive than Leiden

Letters representing numeral

Leiden: $\rho\alpha'$

EpiDoc: **<num value="101">** $\rho\alpha$ **</num>**

In summary

1. EpiDoc must be as expressive as Leiden
2. EpiDoc may express much more, but **must be able to be as ambiguous as Leiden**
3. EpiDoc follows Leiden to define intellectual categories, **not format and sigla**
4. Different communities usage may differ
5. All guidelines and tools progress depend on contributing scholar/project needs



ENCODING OBJECT --- DESCRIPTION

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://relxng.org/ns/structure/1.0"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://purl.oclc.org/dsdl/schematron"?>
<TEI xmlns="http://www.tei-c.org/ns/1.0" xml:space="preserve" xml:lang="en">
```

```
<teiHeader>
  <fileDesc>
    <titleStmt>
      <title>title of document</title>
    </titleStmt>
    <publicationStmt>
      <authority/>
      <idno type="filename"></idno>
    </publicationStmt>
    <sourceDesc>
      <msIdentifier>
        <repository>museum/archive</repository>
        <idno>inventory number</idno>
      </msIdentifier>
      <physDesc>
        <objectDesc>
          <supportDesc>
            <support>description of object/monument (likely to include <material/>
              and <objectType/> information, <dimensions/>, etc.)</support>
          </supportDesc>
          <layoutDesc>
            <layout>description of text field/campus</layout>
          </layoutDesc>
          <objectDesc>
            <handNote>description of letters, possibly including <height>letter-heights</height>
          </handNote>
        </objectDesc>
      </physDesc>
      <history>
        <origin>
          <origPlace>Place of origin</origPlace>
          <origDate>Date of origin</origDate>
        </origin>
        <provenance type="found"> Findspot and circumstances/context
        </provenance>
        <provenance type="observed">Modern location(s) (if different from repository, above)
        </provenance>
      </history>
    </msDesc>
    </sourceDesc>
  </fileDesc>
  <profileDesc>
    <textClass>
      <keywords>
        <term>Type of text</term>
      </keywords>
    </textClass>
  </profileDesc>
</teiHeader>
```

teiHeader

- repository
- physical description (object, layout, and writing)
- origin, findspot and circumstances, location of observation

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text

- text, apparatus, translations, commentary, bibliography

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<text>
  <body>
    <div type="edition" xml:space="preserve">
      <ab>
        <lb n="1">Greek or Latin (etc.) text here
      </ab>
    </div>
    <div type="apparatus">
      <p>external apparatus criticus (if applicable)</p>
    </div>
    <div type="translation">
      <p>translation(s)</p>
    </div>
    <div type="commentary">
      <p>commentary</p>
    </div>
    <div type="bibliography">
      <p>bibliography of previous editions, discussion, etc.</p>
    </div>
  </body>
</text>
```

```
</TEI>
```

Encoding object description

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://relaxng.org/ns/structure/1.0"?>
<?xml-model href="https://epidoc.stoa.org/schema/latest/tei-epidoc.rng" schematypens="http://purl.oclc.org/dsd1/schematron"?>
<TEI xmlns="http://www.tei-c.org/ns/1.0" xml:space="preserve" xml:lang="en">
  <teiHeader>
    <fileDesc>
      <titleStm>
        <title>title of document</title>
      </titleStm>
      <publicationStm>
        <authority></authority>
        <idno type="filename"></idno>
      </publicationStm>
      <sourceDesc>
        <msDesc>
          <msIdentifier>
            <repository>museum/archive</repository>
            <idno>inventory number</idno>
          </msIdentifier>
          <physDesc>
            <objectDesc>
              <supportDesc>
                <support>description of object/monument (likely to include <material/>
                  and <objectType/> information, <dimensions/>, etc.)</support>
              </supportDesc>
              <layoutDesc>
                <layout>description of text field/campus</layout>
              </layoutDesc>
            </objectDesc>
            <handDesc>
              <handNote>description of letters, possibly including <height>letter-heights</height>
            </handNote>
            </handDesc>
          </physDesc>
          <origin>
            <origPlace>Place of origin</origPlace>
            <origDate>Date of origin</origDate>
          </origin>
          <provenance type="found"> Findspot and circumstances/context
          </provenance>
          <provenance type="observed">Modern location(s) (if different from repository, above)
          </provenance>
          </history>
        </msDesc>
      </sourceDesc>
    </fileDesc>
    <profileDesc>
      <textClass>
        <keywords>
          <term>Type of text</term>
        </keywords>
      </textClass>
    </profileDesc>
  </teiHeader>
```

teiHeader

physDesc

Object description <objectDesc>

Support:

<supportDesc>
<support>

- Type
- Condition
- Material
- Dimensions
- Decoration

Text field:

<layoutDesc>
<layout>

- Layout
- Execution

Letters description

<handDesc>

<handNote>

- Height
- Dating
- Palaeography: letterforms, abbr. marks, ligatures, symbols

Support description

<supportDesc>

<support>

<p>Part of a marble stele, cut down for reuse as a column capital: w. 0.365, h. 0.365, d. 0.30. Roughly incised palm branches at the ends of lines 2 and 4.</p>

</support>

</supportDesc>

Support description

<support>

<p>Part of a <material>marble</material> stele, cut down for reuse as a column capital: w. 0.365, h. 0.365, d. 0.30. Roughly incised palm branches at the ends of lines 2 and 4.</p>

</support>

Support description

<support>

<p>Part of a **<material>**marble**</material>**

<objectType>stele**</objectType>**, cut down for reuse as a column capital: w. 0.365, h. 0.365, d. 0.30. Roughly incised palm branches at the ends of lines 2 and 4.**</p>**

</support>

Support description

`<support>`

`<p>`Part of a `<material`
`ref="material.xml#m">`marble`</material>`
`<objectType ref="object.xml#stele">`stele`</objectType>`, cut
down for reuse as a column capital: w. 0.365, h. 0.365, d. 0.30.
Roughly incised palm branches at the ends of lines 2 and 4.`</p>`
`</support>`

Support description

<support>

<p>Part of a **<material
ref="material.xml#m">**marble**</material>**

<objectType ref="object.xml#stele">stele**</objectType>**, cut
down for reuse as a column capital:

<dimensions unit="metre">

<width>0.365**</width>**

<height>0.365**</height>**

<depth>0.30**</depth>**

<dimensions>.

Roughly incised palm branches at the ends of lines 2 and 4.**</p>**

</support>

- **<dim type="diameter">**
- **@precision**
- **@min, @max**

Support description

<support>

<p>Part of a **<material**
ref="material.xml#m">marble**</material>**
<objectType ref="object.xml#stele">stele**</objectType>**, cut
down for reuse as a column capital:
<dimensions><width>0.365**</width><height>**0.365**</height>**
<depth>0.30**</depth></dimensions>**.

Roughly incised **<rs type="decoration">**palm branches**</rs>**
at the ends of lines 2 and 4.**</p>**

</support>

Text field description

`<layoutDesc>`

`<layout>`

Inscribed on the only surviving face.

`</layout>`

`</layoutDesc>`

Text field description

<layoutDesc>

<layout>

<rs type="execution" key="scalpro">Inscribed</rs>

on the only surviving face.

</layout>

</layoutDesc>

Letters description

<handDesc>

<handNote>Probably first century A.D., 0.03,
rather lightly cut between guide-lines; L for ἐτῶν;
bars above L and the figure in line 2.

</handNote>

</handDesc>

Letters description

<handDesc>

<handNote>Probably first century A.D., <height>0.03</height>, rather lightly cut between guide-lines; L for ἐτῶν; bars above L and the figure in line 2.

</handNote>

</handDesc>

Epigraphic Databases

Epigraphic Database Rome

Epigraphic Database Bari

Epigraphic Database Heidelberg

Epigraphic Database Clauss-Slaby

Roman Inscriptions of Britain

Packard Humanities Institute Greek Inscriptions

Attic Inscriptions Online

...

Standard vocabularies

EAGLE vocabularies

EpiVoc

FAIR vocabulary

Record Number: EDR016351 **TM Number:** 287576

Ancient Region: Umb

Current Region: I

Ancient City: Suasa **TMGEO:** 14368

Modern City: Castelleone di Suasa (Ancona)

Discovery Location: Castelleone di Suasa (Ancona),
località Pian Volpello, Podere Conti, a S del fiume
Cesano, sulla strada che scende da Castelleone alla
provinciale

Current Location: Castelleone di Suasa (Ancona),
Museo civico archeologico

Object Type: cippus, terminus

Material: lapis

Writing Technique: scalpro

Language: latina

Inscription type: cetera

Bibliography: SupplIt, 18, 2000, pp. 359-360 nr. 4 con
foto (S. Antolini) (1)

Text:

⟨:in fronte⟩

Fin(es)

Suasanor(um).

⟨:in postica⟩

Fin(es)

Pisaur[e]n(sium).



Apparatus: Textus secundum (1),
contulit ad imaginem Branchesi 2007.
Date: 31 d.C. / 70 d.C.

Author: Fabiola Branchesi Last
update: 19-02-2007 (22-07-2024)

Record Number: EDRo15897 **TM**

Number: 287868

Ancient Region: Umb

Current Region: I

Ancient City: Fanum Fortunae **TMGEO:** 32203

Modern City: Fano (Pesaro e Urbino)

Discovery Location: Fano (Pesaro e Urbino), dal terreno detto "Palombara"

Current Location: Fano (Pesaro e Urbino), Museo Civico

Object Type: stela

Material: marmor

Writing Technique: scalpro

Language: latina

Inscription type: sepulcralis

Type of persons mentioned: cet.

Bibliography: CIL 11, 06261 (1)

R. Bernardelli Calavalle, Le iscrizioni romane del Museo Civico di Fano, Fano 1983, pp. 142-143, con foto (2)

Text:

D(is) M(anibus)

Fortuni=

ae Fort=

tunates

5 matri pi=

entiss=

me, Vitalis

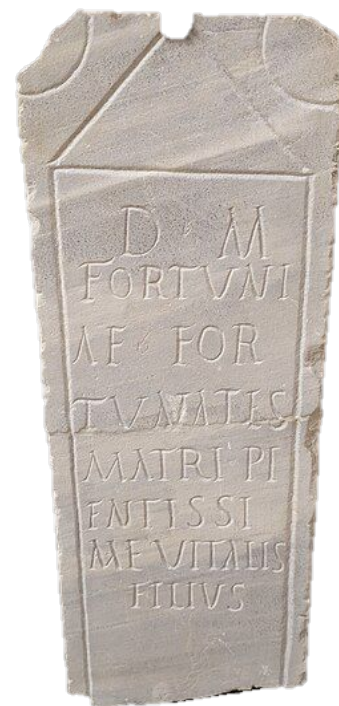
filius.

Apparatus: Textus secundum (1)-(2), contulit ad imaginem Branchesi 2006.

Date: 201 d.C. / 300 d.C.

Author: Fabiola

Branchesi Last update: 02-12-2006



WIKIDATA



Open,
community-
driven platform



Real-time
editing



Multilingual
environment



Interdisciplinary



CCo licence
(fully open data)



Query flexibility



Examples

A recent epigraphic initiative

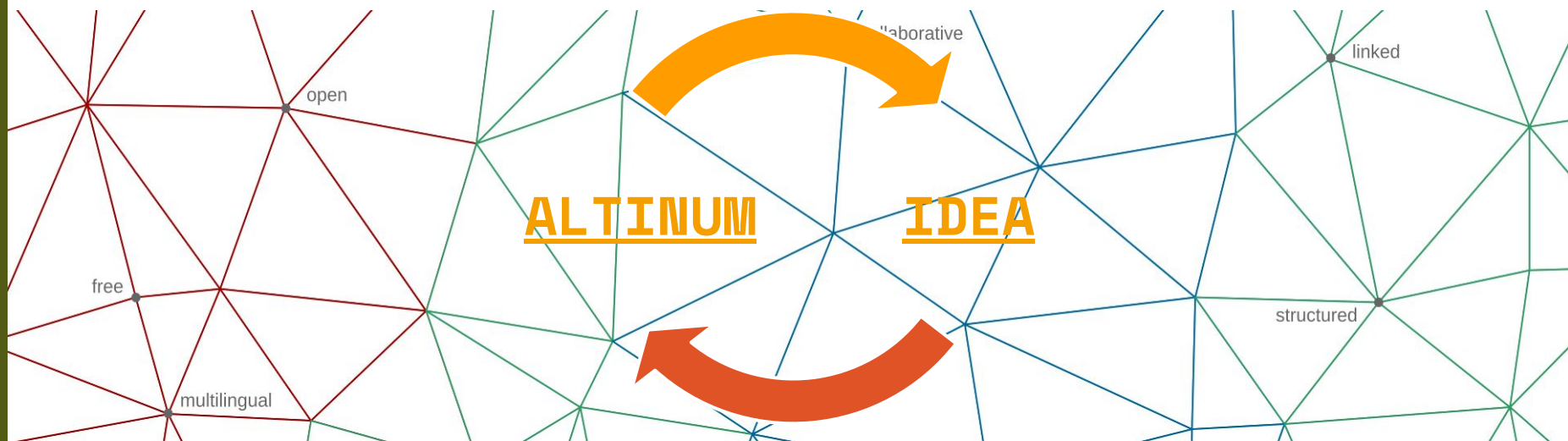
WikiProject Epigraphy

Human label	FAIR vocabulary	Wikidata ID	EAGLE
elogium	type of inscription/ Elogium	Q9252945	typeins/lod/ 70
Boundary marker	type of inscription/ Boundary marker	Q125323565	typeins/lod/ 96
Funerary inscription	type of inscription/ Funerary	Q121614747	typeins/lod/ 283
Acclamation	type of inscription/ Acclamation	Q83390	typeins/lod/ 73
Dedication	type of inscription/ Dedication	Q126733445	typeins/lod/ 88
Building inscription	type of inscription/ Building inscription	Q90766967	typeins/lod/ 263

Matching vocabulary in Wikidata

WikiProject Epigraphy

- work in progress
- FAIR principles
 - Findability, Accessibility, Interoperability, Reusability
- RDF: properties, items, values
(subject-predicate-object)
Example: [Q125323565](#)
- FAIR vocabularies
- Broad matches / close matches / exact matches



Data Models

Example Items

Q126687899



IDEA

Q111931971



ALTINUM

VSC demo and exercise

Description	Panciera/EDH	SEG/DDb	EpiDoc
Line breaks	<i>abc / abc</i>		<lb n="1"/>first line <lb n="2"/>second line
Word divided across lines	<i>abc/def</i>	$\alpha\beta\gamma$ - $\delta\epsilon\zeta$	<lb n="1"/> $\alpha\beta\gamma$ <lb n="2" break="no"/> $\delta\epsilon\zeta$
Text divisions	<i>abc // abc</i>		<div type="textpart">...</div>
Clear but incomprehensible letters	<i>ABC</i>	AB	<orig>abc</orig>
Letters ambiguous outside context	<i>ḁḃ</i>	$\alpha\beta$	<unclear> $\alpha\beta$ </unclear>
Vestiges of letters visible but illegible	+++	...	<gap reason="illegible" quantity="3" unit="character"/>
Text read by previous editor, now lost	<u>abc</u>		<supplied reason="undefined" evidence="previouseditor"> $\alpha\beta\gamma$ </supplied>
Ligatured letters	<i>āb</i>		<hi rend="ligature">ab</hi>
Erased	[<i>abc</i>]	[$\alpha\beta$]	<del rend="erasure"> $\alpha\beta$
Erased and overstruck / corrected	«def»		<subst><del rend="corrected">abc<add place="overstrike">def</add></subst>
Text added by ancient hand	<i>`abc`</i>		<add place="above"> $\alpha\beta$ </add>
Characters lost but restored	[<i>abc</i>]	[$\alpha\beta$]	<supplied reason="lost"> $\alpha\beta$ </supplied>
Characters lost, lacuna	[...]	[...]	<gap reason="lost" quantity="3" unit="character"/>
Lacuna, extent unknown	[---]	[----	<gap reason="lost" extent="unknown" unit="character"/>
Lacuna, approximate extent	[<i>ε.3</i>]		<gap reason="lost" quantity="5" unit="character" precision="low"/>
Line lost	[- - - - -]		<gap reason="lost" quantity="1" unit="line"/>
Line(s) possibly lost	[- - - ?]		<gap reason="lost" quantity="1" unit="line"><certainty match=".." locus="name"/></gap>
Letters suppressed by editor	{abc}	{ $\alpha\beta$ }	<surplus> $\alpha\beta\gamma$ </surplus>
Omitted letters; added by editor	<abc>	< $\alpha\beta$ >	<supplied reason="omitted"> $\alpha\beta$ </supplied>
Letters corrected by editor	┐abc┐	< $\alpha\beta$ >	<choice><corr> $\alpha\beta$ </corr><sic> $\beta\alpha$ </sic></choice>
Expansion of abbreviation	<i>a(bc)</i>	$\alpha(\beta\gamma)$	<expan><abbr> α </abbr><ex> $\beta\gamma$ </ex></expan>
Abbreviation: expansion unknown	<i>a(---)</i>		<abbr> α </abbr>
Editor's note	(!)		<note>!</note>, <note>sic</note>, <note>e.g.</note>
Space left on stone	(vac.3)	<i>v. ; vacat</i>	<space quantity="1" unit="character"/> <space quantity="3" unit="character"/>
Numeral (Roman Greek)	XII	α' ; , α	<num value="12">XII</num> <num value="1"> α </num>
Symbol	(leaf)		<g ref="#leaf"/>

Technical requirements and downloads

1. Install the free [Visual Studio Code](#) editor. If you need any help installing or activating this free software, please speak to your university's IT support as soon as possible. Useful plugins: please go to the **Extensions** button on the left bar (5th button down) and search for:
 1. XML (XML Language Support by Red Hat)
 2. tei-publisher-vscode (Visual Studio Code extension to support TEI editing)
 3. Scholarly XML (XML validator RELAX NG and Schematron)
2. For the EpiDoc exercises: download the [EpiDoc Template](#) (right-click on the link and "save link as...")
3. You may find the [Text Quick Reference](#) sheet a useful overview of text transcription elements, and the [Structured Data Quick Reference](#) a summary of descriptive and historical features.

Find some inscriptions or papyri to work on

1. Starting with a copy of the EpiDoc Template for each new document, create EpiDoc files for 2 or 3 inscriptions, papyri, seals or other text-bearing objects of your choice.
 - Possible sources of inscriptions:
 - Latin inscriptions: [EDH](#), [EDR](#). E.g.: [HD000063](#), [HD000319](#), [EDR000014](#), [EDR000015](#).
 - Greek inscriptions: [PHI](#), [AIUK in AIO](#). E.g. [PH2302](#), [PH334064](#), [AIUK 2 no. 5](#), [AIUK 2 no. 8](#).
 - Papyri: [Papyri.info](#). Suggestions: [BGU 1.4](#), [P.Oxy 5364](#).
 - [ORACC](#) -- if you want to mark up a Cuneiform text
 - [DAMOS](#) -- if you want to mark up a Mycenaean text
 - Inscriptions in English: [Download archive](#), or search for "[broken gravestones](#)" in Wikimedia Commons or your favourite image resource.
2. As discussed in this session, focus on the "Manuscript Description" features of the edition. Encode as many of the features of object description, document history, and other metadata as you can find.
 - The EpiDoc [Structure Quick Reference](#) (PDF) will be a useful guide to encoding
 - For more detail, see EpiDoc Guidelines section on [Descriptive and Historical data](#)
 - If you want to see some examples of already marked-up inscriptions, you may visit [IGCyr](#), [IOSPE](#) or [CGRN](#).

Find some inscriptions or papyri to work on

3. **At least:** Make notes on how the features you are encoding in EpiDoc would be handled in Wikidata, according to the example that Anna Clara has shared or [this document](#). If you can find them, suggest the properties or values (P-numbers/Q-numbers) in Wikidata you would use.

If you like: you may create a basic entry for your inscription in Wikidata, and bring it along to discuss with your class next week.

Optional: Viewing, transforming, searching EpiDoc

1. Pasting your XML into the [iSicily Viewer](#) will display the transcribed text only in standard Leiden format
2. Install the EFES platform onto your laptop, following the [Installation](#) instructions
3. If you are using the Oxygen XML editor ([download](#)) ([30-day free trial](#)), there is an EpiDoc-specific [Oxygen Stylesheets Project](#) (see “[Running EpiDoc Stylesheets](#)” for instructions) for transforming your XML files into HTML pages.